

8.b) The origins and practice of modern Anthropology are bound up with the colonial era. Discuss. (20 marks)

Modern Anthropology is the study of human being it's biology and culture in various space and time.

Origin of Anthropology: bound up with colonial era

~~Prerequisites~~

- ① The origin of anthropology credited to the voyage expeditions.
- ② The voyage expeditions led to exploration.
- ③ Exploration brought in contact with new world and culture.
- ④ To understand the new culture, study of alien culture taken up.
- ⑤ The understanding was necessary to expand the colonial interest.
- ⑥ Better understanding would make it easier to conquer the new world.

Practice of Anthropology : bound up with colonial era

- ① Practice of biasness.
- ② Belief of Superiority.
- ③ Victorian view

All of the above colonial view led to the practice of ETHNOCENTRISM

- ④ Comparison of culture. led to the practice of ETHNOLOGY.

- ⑤ The methodology used were the ETIC Approach

- ⑥ The source of data used was the letters from colonial administrators, official. Use of secondary data.

- ⑦ Evolutionary approach :

L.H. Morgan, E.B. Tyler

Barbaric → Savagery → Civilization

- ⑧ The end point of the society was

- ⑨ ~~Biological anthropology racial studies~~

to achieve the western colonial like society.

① Biological anthropology racial studies.
Thus Modern anthropology started with the colonial era practice.

However, Anthropology has come a long way in shedding the colonial characteristic

Anthropology : From colonial to Common Man

1) The preconceived biasness - making way to subjectivity.

from ETHNOCENTRICISM to CULTURAL RELATIVISM.

2) From EMIT to ETM approach

3) From ethnography to ethno ethnology to ethnography.

4) From evolutionary approach to Historic particularism.

5) Challenging racial studies.

Thus Anthropology has come a long way from being the discipline to cater to colonial master to the discipline of common man.